Year and Name of VDS Scheme	Income Disclosed (₹crore)	Additional Tax Collected (₹ crore)
1951 Tyagi VDS Scheme	70.20	10.89
1965 VDS 60/40 scheme	52.18	30.80
1965 Black scheme	145.00	19.45
1975 Emergency VDS	744.00	248.70
1985 Amnesty Circulars	10,778.00	495.00
1991 Foreign Remittance Scheme	2200.00	200.00
1997 VDIS	33,000.00	9729.00
2015 VDIS Compliance Window	4147.00	2488.00
2016 IDS (Income Declaration Scheme)	65,250.00	29,362.00
2017 PMGKY (Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Yojana)	4900.00	2451.00

At the time of VDIS in 1997, the All-India Federation of Tax Practitioners, stating that such a practice was discriminatory against those who paid their taxes regularly and dutifully, filed a petition in the Supreme Court.

The Supreme Court ruled that such schemes would demoralize honest tax payers and help tax evaders to get away from prosecution by merely paying a penalty. The government had to give an undertaking to the SC that the 1997 VDIS was the last of its kind. Any future scheme would need the prior approval of the SC. As a consequence, for each of the Voluntary Disclosure schemes initiated by the NDA Government (in 2015, 2016 and 2017), the name of the scheme was changed by omitting the word 'amnesty scheme' and putting 'income disclosure scheme' in its place!

As explained above, widening the direct income tax base is undoubtedly a good objective. The questions is, did demonetization succeed in doing so?

As in the case of the other demonetization objectives, there was a spate of statements by various senior government authorities claiming